PROCEDURE AND DRILL CHECKLIST

LOST CHILD PROCEDURE

The first 5 minutes, the next 30, the reunion, and the checklist for a drill twice a season.

Mountain: _____ Prepared by: _____ Date: _____

> This is a template. Have your insurer and attorney review it before adopting. Call local law enforcement as your own written policy says, at the time it sets.

THE FIRST 5 MINUTES

The first person to know a child is missing starts the procedure. Nobody waits to be sure.

1. **Call it.** Any staff member who learns a child is missing calls it in at once: the instructor, the desk, a lift operator, a parent at the ticket window. Use one plain phrase on the radio that everyone knows.
2. **Capture the description.** First name, age, height, jacket and helmet colors, pants, skis or snowboard, the last place and time seen, who they were with, and their ability. Ask whether they have a phone and whether there is a usual meeting place.
3. **Notify patrol.** Patrol dispatch runs the search from here. Give dispatch the description, the last place seen and the radio channel.
4. **Notify lift operators.** Every lift operator watches the load and unload for the description and holds the child at the lift shack if seen. Top stations watch who is getting off.
5. **Watch the base area and parking lots.** Put staff at the base area exits, the lodge doors and the parking lot entrances. Children head for the car, the lodge, the rental shop and the last lift they rode.
6. **Keep the adult in one place.** The parent or the instructor stays at a set point, usually the ski school desk or the patrol room, with a phone, so the child can be returned to them and so they can answer questions.

THE NEXT 30 MINUTES

1. **One person leads.** The patrol director or the person your policy names runs the search, and everyone reports to them.
2. **Search by area.** Assign areas: the class's last run and lift, the terrain park, the tree areas near the beginner terrain, the base area, the lodge restrooms, the rental shop and the parking lots. Record who searched each area and when.
3. **Use what the area already knows.** The last lift scan of the child's ticket, the last class check-in and where the class last reported help narrow it down.
4. **Keep the family informed** at set times, even when there is nothing new.
5. **Widen the search** on the clock your policy sets, and contact local law enforcement when your policy says to.

THE REUNION: VERIFYING THE ADULT

When the child is found, bring them to the set point, not to whoever happens to be nearby.

- Release a child in a lesson only to an adult on the booking's pickup list, after checking photo ID. Follow your pickup and release policy.
- For a child who was with their family, confirm the adult with the child, and check ID if anything is unclear.
- Ask whether the child is hurt, cold or upset. Patrol checks them if there is any doubt.
- Call off the search by radio, with the time, so every searcher hears it.

LOST CHILD DRILL CHECKLIST

- ☐ **Date, time and who ran the drill** written at the top of the record
- ☐ **The call** went out on the radio within one minute of the report, with the agreed phrase
- ☐ **The description** captured in full: first name, age, colors, equipment, last place and time seen
- ☐ **Patrol dispatch** received it and named who leads the search
- ☐ **Every lift operator** confirmed by radio that they are watching
- ☐ **Base area exits, lodge doors and parking lots** covered, with the time each was covered
- ☐ **The adult** kept at the set point with a phone
- ☐ **Search areas** assigned and recorded, each with who and when
- ☐ **The decision on law enforcement** made at the time your policy sets, and recorded
- ☐ **The reunion** at the set point, with the adult verified against the pickup list and photo ID
- ☐ **Search called off** by radio, and every searcher confirmed
- ☐ **Times written down** for each step, compared with your targets
- ☐ **Debrief** held the same day, with what to change and who changes it

Drill run by	Date and time	Time to find